

गणपति बप्पा मोरया

Ganesh Chaturthi

Game Design Contest

This festive season, students are invited to build any game they want, make it fun, make it work, and let everyone play.

Registration form

Registration is open. Submissions close 20 September, 5:00 PM.

Read about the contest →

Key details →



Every new beginning starts with Lord Ganesha, Vighnaharta, the remover of obstacles. In that spirit, students begin something new, clear their bugs one by one, and bring a finished game to the festival for everyone to enjoy.



Key details

Registration is open. Here is everything confirmed so far.

Registration opens

11 September 2026

Open from today

Submissions close

**20 September
by 5:00 PM**

Sunday. Late entries may not be accepted.

Who can enter

Solo or team

Teams of up to 4 members

Rewards worth ₹30,000

Shared across the top three games.

2nd
₹10,000

1st
₹15,000

3rd
₹5,000

What the contest is about

The Ganesh Chaturthi Game Design Contest invites students to build a game or a fun, game-based interactive application. The idea is entirely up to them. Each team picks something it would genuinely like to build, turns it into a working product, and lets students from different campuses play it.

The organizers are not looking for the biggest project or the most complicated code. A small game that feels complete and is fun to replay can do better than a large game that is unfinished, much like a small, lovingly shaped clay murti can mean more than a grand one left half made.



Build a Vinayaka Chaturthi game

Every game must be themed around Vinayaka Chaturthi. The festival is the heart of the contest, so each entry should clearly connect to Lord Ganesha, his stories, or the way the festival is celebrated. Games with no link to the festival will not be considered.

The theme is fixed, but the type of game is each team's choice. A runner, puzzle, quiz, memory, arcade, rhythm or story game all work, as long as the festival is at its centre.

Teams can draw from festival elements such as:

Lord Ganesha's stories

Modaks and festive sweets

Mushak, Ganesha's mouse

Pandals and decorations

Rangoli patterns

Dhol and procession music

Puja, durva and flowers

Visarjan

Eco-friendly clay murtis

A few game ideas to get started

Modak catch. Catch falling modaks in a basket before the plate fills up.

Mushak dash. An endless runner starring Ganesha's little mouse companion.

Pandal puzzle. Assemble a pandal decoration piece by piece against the clock.

Rangoli memory. Match rangoli patterns before the colours fade.

Dhol rhythm. Tap in time with the procession beat and build a combo.

Eco murti maker. Choose natural materials and score points for a greener celebration.

Vinayaka stories quiz. Answer questions on Ganesha's stories and

Visarjan journey. Guide the procession safely through the streets

festival traditions.

to the water.

Puja collector. Gather durva, flowers and offerings before the aarti begins.

These are only starting points. Teams are free to create their own festival idea.

Handle the theme with respect. Lord Ganesha should always be shown with care. Games should not show him being hurt, attacked or mocked.



What every game should have

The idea can be anything, but the final game should feel complete. Before submitting, each team makes sure the basics are covered.

Easy to start

A new player quickly understands what to do.

Working gameplay

The main game loop works without major bugs.

Clear result

A score, time, level, win or loss, progress or another clear outcome is shown.

Proper ending

The player knows when a round or game is finished.

Play again

Players can restart and try again.

Mobile and laptop

The final version works on common mobile and laptop or desktop browsers.

Cross-campus access

Students from every participating campus can open and play it easily, with no campus-specific access restrictions.

Safe content

The game stays suitable for students, with nothing offensive, hateful, explicit or disrespectful.



How the contest will run

1

Register

Students join individually or as a team, either solo or in teams of up to 4.

2

Choose an idea

Each team decides what game it wants to build. There is no fixed genre.

3

Build and test

Teams create the game, test it properly and make sure the basic flow works.

4

Submit

Teams share the game link, code and a short demo before 20 September, 5:00 PM.

5

Play across campuses

Approved games are opened for students from participating campuses to play.

6

Demo and judging

Shortlisted teams may be asked to show their game and explain how they built it.

7

Results

Winners are chosen by judging score and announced by the organizers.



Leaderboards and cross-campus play

Games are meant to be played, not just submitted. After the build round, approved games are shared across campuses so students can try them and compete.

Players can play a game more than once.

For a score-based game, a player's best valid score can appear on the leaderboard.

If a game is based on time, levels or another result, that result can be used instead of a score.

Each game has its own ranking, because different games use different scoring systems.

All game leaderboards may be shown on one common dashboard with campus and game filters.

Raw scores from completely different games are not combined unless the organizers announce a fair common scoring method.

No natural score? That's fine. The team adds a simple measurable result such as completion time, level reached, number of wins, stars collected, or any other result that makes sense for the game.



What each team submits

Game title

The name of the game.

Live game link

A working link that judges and students from every participating campus can open and test, with the required access and permissions enabled.

Source code

A GitHub or repository link, or the source package requested by the organizers.

How to play

A short note covering controls and the goal of the game.

Demo video

A 1 to 3 minute recording showing the game from start to finish.

Team details

Team name, members, student IDs, campus and team lead details.

Tools used

The main framework, libraries, assets or tools used.

Documentation should stay short. Judges should be able to understand the game without reading a long report.



What makes a game stand out

The actual playing experience matters most, not the amount of code written.

Fun and playability

Creativity

It's enjoyable, and players want to play again.

The game has its own idea, twist or personality.

Completeness

The full flow works from start to result and restart.

Ease of use and look

Controls, screens and feedback are easy to understand.

Technical quality

It runs smoothly and avoids major bugs.

Demo and explanation

The team can clearly show the game and explain what it built.



Simple rules

Entries must be games or fun, game-based interactive applications. General utility apps, dashboards, business tools and other non-game projects will not be considered.

The submitted game must be functional. If the link does not open or the main gameplay does not work during evaluation, the entry may not be evaluated.

Each team builds its own game. Libraries, starter code and development tools are allowed, but copied or plagiarized projects, or someone else's complete game, are not.

Coding assistants and AI tools may be used if the organizers allow them. The team must still understand the code and be able to explain the important parts.

Teams use only images, music, characters and other assets they have permission to use.

No offensive, explicit, hateful, discriminatory, or culturally or religiously disrespectful content. Festival themes, in particular, should be handled with

care and respect.

Games must not collect passwords, payment information or unnecessary personal data from players.

Faking scores, automating score submissions or manipulating the leaderboard is not allowed.

Teams submit before the announced deadline and keep their game link working throughout the contest.

If judges ask for a code walkthrough, the team should be able to explain how the game works.



**Pick an idea. Build it. Test it.
Let people play it.**

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